SAMPLE DESIGN - NOT A COMPLETED CLIENT STUDY

Understanding access to community services.

An example of how a research brief can connect a practical question, an appropriate approach, and clear deliverables. No data has been collected and no results are reported.

01 / THE DECISION

A hypothetical development organization wants to decide which barriers to address when adapting a community service program.

02 / THE RESEARCH QUESTIONS

- Who knows about the service, and who does not?
- What practical, social, or information barriers affect access?
- How do participants describe their experience?
- Which changes should be considered for further testing?

03 / AN ILLUSTRATIVE APPROACH

Combine a structured household survey with participant interviews and conversations with program implementers. Review existing program records where permission and suitability allow.

PARTICIPANTS & SCOPE

Adults in selected program communities, with attention to people who use the service and those who do not. The number of sites and participants should be determined from the objectives, access conditions, and available resources.

Planning note: this sample deliberately avoids claiming a representative sample or promising a fixed timeline before the context is known.

FROM DESIGN TO DOCUMENTATION

A visible process.
A useful set of outputs.

04 / PARTICIPANT CARE

Explain the purpose of the study and voluntary participation in appropriate language. Agree consent, privacy, recontact, and any ethics-review requirements before collection. Avoid collecting identifiers that are not needed.

05 / FIELD QUALITY

Pilot the instruments. Brief interviewers on wording and difficult situations. Agree supervision and validation checks, document access issues and changes, and keep a clear data-cleaning log.

06 / ANALYSIS

Describe reach and reported barriers within the limits of the selected sample. Examine interview themes alongside survey findings. Separate observed patterns from possible explanations and avoid causal claims the design cannot support.

07 / POTENTIAL DELIVERABLES

- Agreed study protocol and piloted instruments
- Fieldwork documentation and quality review log
- An anonymized dataset and codebook, where appropriate
- Findings brief with limitations and areas for further investigation

Adaptation checklist: confirm the decision, study population, locations, language needs, permissions, budget, timeline, and intended use of the findings before commissioning.